CHAPTER 36

TEXTGATE

2–6 August 2012

ENGLAND vs SOUTH AFRICA, 2nd Test, *Headingley, Leeds*

South Africa 419 and 258/9 dec.; England 425 and 130/4

Match drawn

England 1st innings: **K Pietersen 149**

James Taylor has been added to the team for the game against South Africa. We are sitting in the dressing room at Headingley during practice, two days before the game. The team have been trying to create a better atmosphere to walk into than some of the dressing rooms that we have experienced before. There is always going to be some healthy competition, but we have spoken about how we remember our debuts and try to make sure new players feel like they are not being shut out but more welcomed in. James is sitting in the dressing room, introducing himself properly to the players. We are all speaking to him, trying to make sure he gets bedded in quickly. When he leaves the room, Kevin Pietersen turns to the player next to him and whispers, 'What's that guy's name?'

It has been a problem that has been brewing for a while now. At first, it's just small things, like him not coming out to dinner regularly, or the feeling that he isn't putting the team first. He's an incredible cricketer, at his best, brutal and capable of crushing and dismantling any bowling attack. It's proving difficult, though, for Strauss and Flower to keep him feeling like a productive member of the team as his stock rises and rises. Two days later, Kevin is batting with James Taylor. We can feel that something isn't right with Kevin: he's angry and discontent. As the players walk off for lunch,